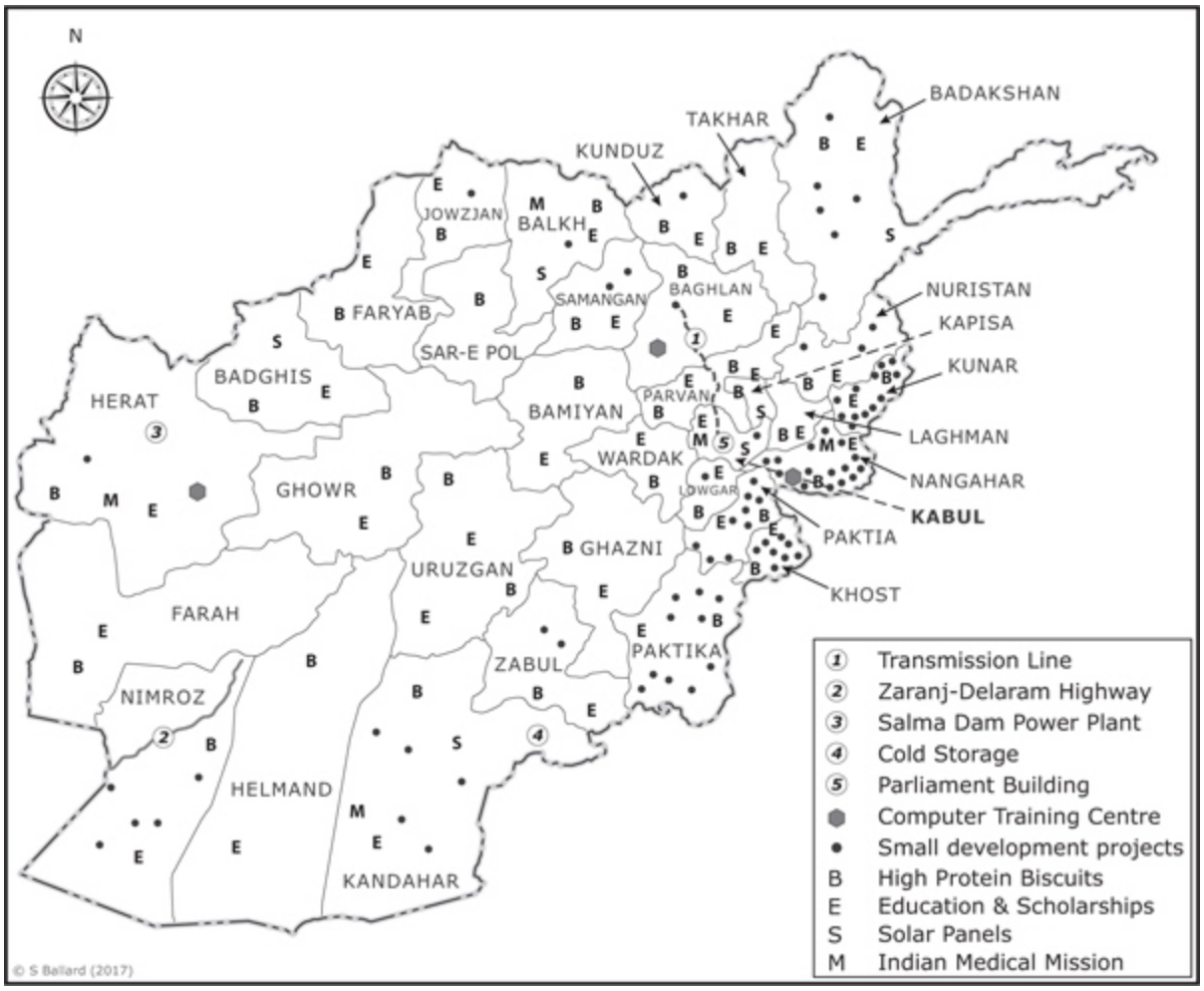


Figure 1: India's Small Development Projects in Afghanistan[33]

With higher stakes came more stakeholders. In addition to the government officials, strategic experts, and media outfits (that constituted the partisans and the conciliators throughout the 1990s), newer stakeholders emerged during the 2002–15 period. Though the PM, the NSA, the MEA and other foreign and security policy institutions were still the most powerful actors charting the policy course, private and public sector businesses and Indian chambers of commerce gained policy influence. The Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) and the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), for instance, became enablers of India's developmental footprint in Afghanistan.[37] Strategic think tanks such as the Observer Research Foundation (ORF), which is closely linked to the Reliance Industries as well as the MEA, and the MoD-sponsored